LITTLE WONDERS ESL

Geography Word Lab: Rivers

Level B1 · about 25 minutes · from the source to the sea



1 BRAIN TEASERS

Read the clue. Write the English word in the boxes.

1. I am the place where a river begins, often in the mountains. ☐☐☐☐☐☐
2. I am a small stream that joins a bigger river. ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐
3. I am a flat area of mud and sand near the mouth of a river. ☐☐☐☐☐

2 COOL FACT: THE JOURNEY OF A RIVER

A river begins at its **source**, often in the mountains, where rain or melting snow makes a small **stream**. The stream flows downhill and gets bigger. A stream that joins a bigger river is called a **tributary**. In the middle part, the river is wider and slower. At the end, the river reaches its **mouth**, where it flows into a sea or a lake. Near the mouth, many rivers form a **delta**, which is a flat area of mud and sand. The **Nile** in Africa is about 6,650 kilometres long.

downhill = down a slope
mouth = the end of a river
wider = bigger from side to side
mud = wet earth

3 WORD HUNT

Across or down

M	O	U	T	H	R	R	I	V	E	R	I
S	R	B	E	L	T	A	I	N	C	L	C
O	I	S	T	R	I	B	U	T	A	R	Y
U	A	I	I	D	S	Q	N	I	O	M	E
R	N	I	E	E	S	R	A	N	I	L	E
C	I	E	T	L	E	S	T	R	E	A	M
E	F	O	A	T	A	L	O	O	E	A	I
E	O	D	E	A	E	N	W	I	T	T	I

WORD BANK

- ☐ **source**
- ☐ **tributary**
- ☐ **delta**
- ☐ **river**
- ☐ **mouth**
- ☐ **stream**
- ☐ **Nile**
- ☐ **sea**

4 SPEAK

Tell your teacher in your own words (about 1 minute)

1. Where does a river begin?
2. What is a tributary?
3. Where does a river end?